

The Novo Nordisk Foundation
Center for Biosustainability



Reference letter for Chris Weingarten

To whom it may concern,

I am writing this letter in support of Christopher Weingarten.

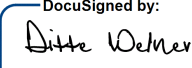
Chris is an absolutely stellar young scientist. I hired Christopher as a research assistant in my lab at the Center for Biosustainability at the Danish Technical University (DTU) in September 2024. Over the course of his one-year contract, he is primarily focused on engineering the fluorinase, a challenging enzyme catalyzing the formation of a carbon-fluoride bond. Despite its high relevance for industrial application, the fluorinase has been difficult to establish in industry due to its low turnover rate, making it an attractive engineering target. Since beginning his role, he has quickly immersed himself in the project, introducing single-point mutations predicted to have higher activity by a sparse-data machine learning model. He was very quickly able to present preliminary results in my lab meetings, demonstrating his aptitude to quickly pick up on a project and effectively communicate his results.

In addition to his direct efforts on engineering the fluorinase, he is also working on developing a high-throughput screening method for performing directed evolution – a significant advancement given the absence of a biosensor for the fluorinase product. Leveraging yeast display, GPCR signaling, and computational protein redesign, Christopher has demonstrated proficiency in a wide variety of technologies, as well as his ability to learn new skills on the job.

In his short time in my lab, Christopher has impressed me with his innovativeness, quickly picking up new concepts and technologies while also transferring previously learned skills to his current project. Especially his remarkable autonomy and ability to independently address challenges has shown him to be a great enrichment to my lab. He has a strong appetite for science and contributes significantly to the scientific environment in my lab, with curiosity, insight, and strong collaborative skills.

I wholeheartedly endorse Christopher as a strong candidate for the job – he'll be a great asset to any work place. Please do not hesitate to reach out if you have any further inquiries about Christopher's professional qualifications. Give me a call (+45 93513498) or an email (diwel@biosustain.dtu.dk)

Best regards,

DocuSigned by:
 3/19/2025
37C8B608412F4EA...

Ditte Hededam Welner, assoc. professor
Enzyme Engineering and Structural Biology group
Technical University of Denmark